

Deep Patel
CSE-AIML

Company: Barclays

Job Profile: Software Developer

Offer Type: Placement Only

CTC: 13.5 LPA

Location: Pune

Process Date:

OA round : 26th July 2025

PPT + Interviews - 29th July 2025

Resume:  **Deep_Mahesh_Patel.pdf**

Contact: 9152743762

Placement Process:

1 .**OA Round** [135 candidates appeared, 37 shortlisted]

The OA consisted of 3 sections, as detailed below:

Section 1: MCQs (Core CS Concepts)

This section mostly included OOPs, SQL Basics, output based questions on C/C++/Java. There were a couple of tricky questions related to OOPs, while the SQL questions were pretty straightforward. Weightage of each question varied.

Section 2: DSA Coding Question

Problem: [String Generation](#)

This was the most difficult section of the OA. The coding question was a medium difficulty question and was based on string. The question was on a constructive side rather than requiring any kind of data structure or algorithm to be solved. I was able to pass all test cases.

Section 3: SQL Query (Implementation-Based)

It was an Easy problem which could be solved using multiple conditions in the WHERE clause

Tips:

- MCQs turned out to be the deciding factor, as most students were able to fully solve the DSA and SQL questions. Focus on practicing MCQs extensively, especially during the final phase of your placement preparation. I personally used GeeksforGeeks and Sanfoundry for preparing Java/C++ MCQs.
- Always make sure to go through the types of questions a company has asked in previous years. This proved to be very helpful for students who had done so for this OA :)
- If you're unable to think of an optimized solution right away, start with a brute-force approach or use the hit-and-trial method. The goal is to pass as many test cases as possible within the limited time, even if the logic isn't the most efficient initially.
- **Make sure you have ample sleep before the day of the interview as it is going to be a very long day ahead.**

2. Tech Round 1 [37 candidates appeared, 19 Shortlisted] (Lasted around 45 Minutes)

The round began with the typical “Introduce Yourself” question. It is important to plan this thoroughly, as it often sets the tone for the rest of the interview. A well-structured introduction can guide the flow of the conversation toward your strengths and areas you are most comfortable discussing. While introducing yourself, try to subtly highlight any project/internship/competition that might catch the interviewer's interest.

In my case it was a website which I had made for my father's company which automated a lot of repetitive tasks. The interviewer was curious about the same and we went on to discuss it for a couple of minutes.

Next, I was asked to code the classic string permutations problem. Always make sure to explain your thought process and dry run for the same first then start coding. Even while coding, explain each line as you are typing.

Then we had a discussion about some of my other projects in my resume and the interviewer questioned me for my choice of the tech stack for each of them.

The interview concluded with me asking two non-technical company related questions.

Tips:

- In case you are asked a question which you have seen/solved previously, **do not make the mistake of directly jumping onto the optimized solution**. Start off with the brute force, then go on to explain how you would improve your code to get the most optimal

solution possible. You do not want the interviewer to know that you are already aware about the problem.

- If you are stuck on a question, first explain your approach to the interviewer and ask for hints afterwards. Most of the time, they are interested in your thought process and how well you are able to communicate and understand the problem.
- Have 2-3 unique projects which you can talk hours about. Have the **what, why and how prepared for each project** ready. It is always a plus if you've worked on a project with real world impact.
- Try to use SQL databases as many times, you might be asked to discuss the schema designs.

3. Techno-HR round [19 candidates appeared] (lasted around 45 minutes)

It was a technical + HR for most of the candidates, but in my case it was completely HR based. The round started again with the introduce yourself question. This time, I made sure to give more emphasis towards my position of responsibilities and the competitions I had taken part in. Following are the questions asked:

- How did I deal with team conflicts that might have occurred during the span of my tenure
- Another question focused on whether I had ever faced a situation where I had to make an **unethical decision**, and how I dealt with it
- My strengths and weaknesses. (Ensure that you mention the steps you are taking to overcome your weaknesses)
- Where do I see myself in 5 years
- How would I go on to work on a piece of tech that I have little to no idea about

Tips:

- Research about the company values beforehand and try to answer the questions organically in a way which aligns with them, for Barclays, these included **RISES** principles
- Thoroughly explain your thought process for decision-making questions, including how you weighed the pros and cons in each scenario.
- Try to ask good questions at the end of the interview. This is to ensure that the interviewer remembers you throughout the process

After a long wait, **16 candidates were offered the job.**

Resources:

Category	Resource/Platform	Key Strategy/Notes
OA & Aptitude	IndiaBix	Good for topics including (percentages, ratios, time-distance).
DSA	Striver's A2Z DSA Sheet	Understanding patterns is crucial. Always spend 30-45 mins before looking at the solution. I had solved around 75% of the SDE sheet.
Java OOPs	Kunal Kushwaha Playlist & GFG Notes	If you have time, go through the entire playlist as it is very extensive
DBMS	GFG, Code-Help Babbar	Supplement lecture notes with these for fast review.
CN	GFG CN Notes	Supplement lecture notes with these for fast review.
OS	GFG OS Notes	Supplement lecture notes with these for fast review.
SQL	Leetcode 50 questions	This should be enough for most of the on campus roles.
Research	Perplexity	Quick and reliable tool to research company background, tech stack, news, and interview experiences.
HR	Indiabix+ChatGPT	Use them to prepare for general HR questions. Use LLMs to tailor your answers according to company values.

General Tips:

A quick backstory about my placement journey -

I began my DSA preparation after the 5th semester but had shifted focus entirely to investment banking for the three months leading up to placement season. Unfortunately, I couldn't clear the Group Discussion round of the J.P.M.C interview, which was a major setback. It was disheartening, as I hadn't ever expected to be eliminated in the very first round.

It was hard for me to switch back to DSA after the long break. But after a lot of practice, I was able to get back on track. After facing 6 rejections, I was able to crack this offer.

Things to keep in mind:

- Your communication skills matter a lot during the interview. Practice thinking out loud while solving DSA problems
- A well crafted resume can help you right from shortlisting to the final HR round. Aim for an ATS score of 70+ on platforms like Resume Worded
- Luck plays a quiet but powerful role during this season. Sometimes, despite giving your all, it slips away; other times, it finds you when you least expect it.
- Gear up for a potential emotional roller coaster, bound by anxiety, fear, hopelessness, and joy at last. This phase of life will teach you a lot, make sure to learn from every rejection. All you need is one good day. Sooner or later, if you've prepared sincerely, that day will come.
- Make sure to participate in Hackathons (and Case Study Competitions if you are preparing for PM/IB/DA roles). They are a great way of developing good projects and learning new things.
- If you're preparing for a non-tech role, evaluate whether you can also do at least basic DSA preparation in parallel. It proved to be one of the best decisions in my case.
- If you don't get selected, don't be disheartened there's always another company and another chance. Stay focused, stay hopeful, and keep moving forward.

ALL THE BEST FOR YOUR PLACEMENT !!

Feel free to reach out in case of any queries